

LSE Ethical Review Questions

Section A: About the study

A1. Title of research project /study

Impostor Phenomenon Moves Online: a study of LinkedIn usage and feelings of impostor phenomenon

A2. Abstract

Your abstract should outline in non-technical language the purpose of the research (Approx. 150-200 words)

Those who experience impostor phenomenon (sometimes referred to as impostor syndrome) tend to compare themselves to others and often reach the conclusion that they come up short. With the rise of social media, you now have the chance to compare yourself whenever and wherever you are. Since for impostor phenomenon this comparison often occurs in the work sphere, LinkedIn in particular is the perfect avenue for the spread of these feelings of inferiority. Therefore, this research will investigate, using questionnaires, whether the usage of LinkedIn (how much it is used and in what ways) has an impact on feelings of impostor phenomenon. No research to date has connected impostor phenomenon to use of social media and therefore this study will contribute significant insights to the literature.

A3. Data Collection

Briefly describe the data collection method(s) to be used (Approx. 100-150 words)

Data will be collected on Gorilla, a cloud-based research platform for creating online experiments. Gorilla stores participant data on secure and GDPR-compliant servers. The first page will contain information on: study background, procedure, risks and benefits of taking part, participants' right to anonymity and to withdraw their data and the research organizers. Following this, participants will be asked to consent to take part in the study. Next, participants will answer a demographic information questionnaire (collecting data on age, gender, ethnicity, occupation). Afterwards, the main study will commence. Participants will be asked to fill in a series of questionnaires in the following order: a self-designed questionnaire on LinkedIn usage, the Iowa-Netherlands Comparison Measure (used to measure social comparison), the Clance Impostor Phenomenon Scale (used to measure feelings of impostor phenomenon). Finally, the participants will see a debrief screen with information about the true aim of the study, relevant resources if they need them and who to contact if they want to withdraw their data or have any questions.

A4. In what country or countries will data collection take place? Will you travel there, or will the research be conducted remotely/online?

Research will be conducted online with the ability to include participants from any country

A5. Will your study be conducted in the LSE Behavioural Lab?

No

A6. When do you expect to begin data collection?

December

A7. What is the approximate duration of your data collection?

About two months

Section B: Researcher Details

B1. Your Name

Rebeka Prívovníková

B2. Are you the lead researcher (at LSE) on the project?

If you are, for example, completing this ethics review for your dissertation, then you are the lead researcher.

Yes

B3. Name and email address of supervisor

Students should enter the name/email address of their project/dissertation/thesis supervisor (or academic mentor/advisor) as appropriate.

Dr Deema Awad d.awad@lse.ac.uk

Section C: Does your study require research ethics approval?

C1. Will your research/study involve ANY of the following?

- a) Human participants (e.g. for interviews, focus groups, observations, etc.)

Yes

- b) The collection or use of any personal data/identifiable information (e.g. names, email addresses, IP addresses, social media data, visual material, etc.)

No

- c) Any other information that could identify (or potentially lead to the identification of) a living individual. For example, where information from micro datasets, if combined, could lead to the identification of individuals.

No

- d) The potential that findings/conclusions may have repercussions for any individuals or groups (in cases of either primary or secondary data analysis)

No

C2. Is there any other reason why your research might raise ethical issues, or why you need ethics approval?

No

C3. Will the research involve accessing security-sensitive material, such as material related to terrorism or violent extremism of any kind?
No

Section D: LSE vs external research ethics review

D1. Does your research/study involve NHS health or social care patients or carers?

If your study will involve research participants identified from, or because of their past or present use of NHS services (adult and children's healthcare within the NHS and adult social care), or relatives or carers of past or present users of these services, you may need to obtain NHS REC approval. If you are unsure, please consult the Health Research Authority (HRA) Decision tool(<http://www.hra-decisiontools.org.uk/ethics/>)
No

D2. Is the study part of a collaborative research project that will undergo ethics review by another university Research Ethics Committee (referred to as Institutional Review Boards in some countries)?
No

D3. Is there any other reason why the research will undergo ethics review by an organisation other than the LSE?
No

Section F: Type of ethics review

F1. Does the research involve vulnerable participants?

Note that vulnerability may be due to a number of factors, for instance: age, potential marginalisation, disability, disadvantageous power relationships within personal or professional roles, etc. Young people under the age of 18 may also be potentially vulnerable.
No

F2. Does the study involve children aged 16 or under?
No

F3. Will the research involve asking participants to respond to questions that might involve the discussion of sensitive topics?

For example: where research intrudes into the private sphere or delves into some deeply personal experience; where the study is concerned with deviance or social control; where the study impinges on the vested interests of powerful persons or the exercise of coercion or domination; where the research deals with things that are sacred to those being studied that they do not wish profaned; or where discussion of the topic could place the participant (or researcher) at risk.
No

F4. Does the study involve any use of deception, and/or will participants not be fully informed at the start as to what the study is about)?

Deception can occur at a variety of levels: for example, at one level, experimental methods may depend on participants being deliberately misled as to the true nature or purpose of the research in which they are taking part; at another, covert participant observation may entail an implicit deception as to the true identity and role of the researcher. Deception may be a legitimate and necessary feature of social scientific research, but its use must always be properly justified.

Participants will not be fully informed of the aims of the study prior to consent and completion to avoid any influences of the aims on the individual's responses, as much information as possible will be provided without disclosing the full aims. Directly following completing the study, participants will be provided with a debrief, detailing the full aims of the study and their right to withdraw their data.

F5. Does the study entail the collection of any biometric data?

No

F6. For primary data collection, will you be collecting written consent from all participants?

Written consent does not need to comprise a hard copy signature. Typed confirmation is acceptable.

For online surveys, written consent could be via an explicit tick-box after the study information is presented at the start of the survey. For secondary data please select 'N/A'. However, the researcher should ensure, where relevant, that consent was given for the data to be used by third parties.

Yes

F7. Is there any reason the research might present any risks to either yourself or your participants?

For instance, if the research is politically sensitive and might attract the attention of authorities

No

F8. Is there any reason why the research requires review/approval by the Research Ethics Committee (as opposed to Departmental review/approval)?

For example, if REC approval is required by the funder or to satisfy other external requirements.

No

Section G: Ethics Review Questions (i)

G1. What participants will be involved in your study? How will they be identified/recruited? Are there any inclusion / exclusion criteria? If yes, describe them.

Students (above 18) and professionals using LinkedIn. They will be recruited online through the dissemination of the research questionnaire through various sources such as relevant

interest groups or the LSE Behavioural Lab mailing list. In order to be included in the study a person will have to be a LinkedIn user.

G2. If you need to recruit participants via a gatekeeper*, please give details. (Might this raise issues of whether participants' involvement is truly voluntary? Might the gatekeeper influence potential participants in some other way?)

**A gatekeeper could be anyone who the researcher needs to go through in order to gain access to participants.*

No

G3. Will any incentives be offered to participants for taking part in the research? If so please give details. (Might this unduly influence their decision as to whether or not to take part?)

No

G4. Are there any payments or other incentives to the researcher(s) that might be perceived as having an impact on the objectivity of the research?

No

G5. Outline how participants will be given information about the study and what their involvement will be, and how you will record consent. If you will not be obtaining informed consent you must explain why.

Please see the guidance on informed consent, which includes a sample template. (N.B. You will be asked to attach a copy of your planned participant information sheet and consent form at the end of the online ethics portal.)

There will be a screen before the beginning of the questionnaires informing the participants about the study and their involvement in it. Here they will also have to indicate their consent with participation by ticking a checkbox (without ticking this checkbox they will not be able to proceed). Copies of the planned participation information sheet, consent sheet and debrief sheet are attached to this form.

G6. Will participants be fully anonymized in your research outputs (dissertation, thesis, publications)? If not, please provide a rationale as to why.

Yes

G7. Describe any other potential risks that your project might pose to participants, and what safeguards will you put in place to address or mitigate these.

Note that harm could be physical, emotional, psychological or reputational. If your study will involve children/participants under the age of 16, question H1 (next section) will address this.

Some psychological harm could be caused to participants by recalling emotions regarding to capability, self-esteem and related topics. This will be addressed at the end of the study by providing resources they can access if the study has brought up any uncomfortable emotions for them.

G8. Describe how you intend to handle issues of confidentiality and anonymity, both in your collection of data and in your study outputs.

At no point will I ask my participants for their name or any other information that could directly identify them. Hence, anonymity will be upheld throughout the study and in its outputs as well. Participants will only be asked for their age and not their date of birth, hence, eliminating any chance of being able to identify them through this information.

G9. Describe any potential risks that your project might pose to you as the researcher or any other researchers involved in study. How will you mitigate these?

Note that risks could be emotional, psychological, reputational, physical
N/A

G10. Will the study provide any benefits to participants or third parties?

No

G11. Might the dissemination of the study results adversely affect (directly or indirectly) any individuals or groups? If so, are there ways you can mitigate this?

No

G12. If you will be working with (or employing) other researchers: describe the principles of good practice that you will follow, addressing issues such as ownership of data and co-authorship. How will you ensure that any local research assistants you hire will receive a fair and appropriate return for their work? How will you maintain the integrity and good reputation of the discipline?

If not relevant, please enter N/A

N/A

G13. If you plan to use any crowd-sourcing platforms (such as MTurk, Prolific Academic) to collect data, please give details here.

Note that researchers should treat participants on crowd-sourcing platforms fairly. Thus, researchers should ensure that they set fair rates of pay; enable easy ways of communication between participants and researcher, etc.). If you have never used these platforms before, please seek training before doing so. If not relevant, please enter N/A

Section H: Ethics Review Questions (ii)

H1. Will your research involve children / young people aged 16 or under?

[If Yes] Please give details of what their involvement will be and what safeguards you will put in place; Please clarify whether parental/guardian consent will also be obtained. Please download and read the NCB Guidelines for Research with Children and Young People (<https://www.ncb.org.uk/sites/default/files/field/attachment/NCB%20guidelines%20CYP.pdf>). Please also refer to the LSE Safeguarding Policy (<https://info.lse.ac.uk/staff/services/Policies-a-procedures/Assets/Documents/safPol.pdf>) You may be asked to obtain a Disclosure and Barring Service check. Please confirm that you have read these guidelines.

No

H2. If the study involves discussion of sensitive topics*, please give details and how you intend to handle this.

**For example - but not limited to - sexual activity, illegal behaviour or social control, experience of violence or abuse, drug use, a topic/issue considered sacred or taboo to the participants, etc.*

Please ensure you upload a copy of your interview question guide and/or survey questions at the end of the form.

There will be no discussion of particularly sensitive topics but relevant resources will be provided to participants at the end of the study as part of the debrief in case the study does evoke any uncomfortable feelings in any of the participants.

H3. Is there a potential risk that participants might disclose information indicating that they or someone else is at risk of significant harm? If so, how would you deal with this?

No

H4. If you plan to collect verbal, rather than written consent, please indicate why this is? Please

also indicate how you will record their consent (e.g. by audio recording, or by a witness)

N/A

H5. If the research involves the use of deception in any way, please give details and explain how you will de-brief participants at the end of the study.

Please refer to the British Psychological Society's Code of Human Research Ethics

There will be slight deception involved as telling the participants outright what the purpose of the study is might affect their answers in the questionnaire. Therefore, on the initial screen where information will be provided to the participants it will be more vague but at the end of the study (once the participants have completed all of the questionnaires) there will be another information debriefing the participants giving them full information on what the purpose of the study is and giving them a chance to withdraw their data if they no longer wish to participate in the study based on this information.

Section J: Previous experience and covering comments

J1. Outline any previous experience and/or ethics training that you have that is relevant to this study

If you will be conducting interviews on a sensitive topic, it would be helpful to know if you have any previous interview experience

Not applicable as I, as the lead researcher on this project, am a student and therefore do not have any previous experience or ethics training beyond that provided by my degree programme.

J2. If there are any covering comments you would like to flag to the reviewer(s), please add them here.

Otherwise just add 'N/A' These comments will appear at the TOP of your review form when received by your supervisor or the Research Ethics Committee for review.

N/A